

UNIT 53



TIME OFF

CONVERSATION

Lisa (HR): Hi Anna, hi Mark! How are you today?

Anna: Hi Lisa... I'm okay... just tired. Carrying the baby is harder than I expected.

Lisa: I can imagine. Are you managing alright?

Anna: Yeah... mostly excited. I wanted to make sure my maternity leave is ready.

Lisa: Of course! Your maternity leave must be requested before you go. Have you sent the form?

Anna: Yes, last week.

Lisa: Perfect. Then it might be approved this week.

Anna: Oh, that's a relief... thank you!

Mark: Speaking of leave... I've done some extra hours recently, so I guess I can take some time off, right?

Lisa: Ah, TOIL — Time Off In Lieu. It can be used after the extra hours are added. Have you sent your timesheets?

Mark: Yep, sent them yesterday.

Lisa: Great. Then your TOIL days might be approved soon.

Mark: Oh, and last month I took sick leave but forgot the doctor's note. That's okay, right?

Lisa: Sick leaves must have a doctor's note. Otherwise, it cannot be approved.

Mark: Thanks! I'll make sure everything is sent properly next time.

Anna: Thanks, Lisa.



VOCABULARY



Vacation



TOIL/
Compensatory
time



Day off



Public holiday



Paternity leave



Maternity leave



Sick leave



Bereavement leave

LANGUAGE PRACTICE

Passive voice with modals and semi-modals

Can sick leave **be approved** without a doctor's note?

No, a note **must be provided** first.

When do vacation days **need to be scheduled**?

They **must be planned** before the new quarter.



UNIT 53



TIME OFF

EXERCISE 1

Choose the correct word from the box: **vacation, day-off, maternity leave, paternity leave, sick leave, bereavement leave, personal day, TOIL**

- A. After working 10 extra hours this month, Mark can take a _____.
- B. Emma is pregnant and will start her _____ next month.
- C. Tom has a fever and cannot come to work today. He needs _____.
- D. Sarah lost her grandmother and will request _____ to attend the funeral.
- E. James wants a Friday to take care of some personal errands, so he takes a _____.
- F. The company gives employees some extra free time once a year for a long trip. They can take _____.
- G. Alex worked late yesterday, so today he has a _____ to rest.
- H. John's partner is having a baby, and he will take _____ to be with the family.

EXERCISE 2

Complete the sentences with the correct passive form using **must, can, need to, or cannot**:

- A. Maternity leave _____ requested before the baby is born.
- B. TOIL days _____ used only after the extra hours are added.
- C. Sick leave _____ approved without a doctor's note.
- D. Personal days _____ requested in advance, but it's polite to do so.
- E. Bereavement leave _____ granted when a close family member dies.
- F. Vacation days _____ scheduled according to the manager's approval.
- G. Paternity leave _____ requested when a baby is born.
- H. Day-off _____ taken by employees who need a short break.

SUMMARY

Modal / Semi-modal	Structure	Example	Use
must	must + be + past participle	Maternity leave must be requested before the baby is born.	Obligation / Rule
can	can + be + past participle	TOIL days can be taken after extra hours are added.	Possibility / Option
cannot / can't	cannot + be + past participle	Sick leave cannot be approved without a doctor's note.	Prohibition
need to	need to + be + past participle	Vacation requests need to be confirmed by HR.	Requirement / Necessity

EXERCISES ANSWER KEYS

Exercise 1

- A. TOIL
- B. Maternity leave
- C. Sick leave
- D. Bereavement leave
- E. Personal day
- F. Vacation
- G. Day-off
- H. Paternity leave

Exercise 2

- A. must be
- B. can be
- C. cannot be
- D. need to be
- E. must be
- F. can be
- G. need to be
- H. can be